Teacher and cover plan — Analysing curated spaces and audience impact

Pathway: SUMMIT · Week 4 Part 2 · Big question: How do curatorial choices — scale, lighting angle, sightlines, and framing — shape audience meaning in an exhibition?

Learning goals and studio kit

• Analyse how directional lighting (raking side light vs flat front light) transforms 3D relief artwork.

• Evaluate exhibition case studies across four curatorial variables: Sightline height, Spatial grouping, Lighting angle, and Interpretation.

• Test directional lighting on your own structural relief panel and produce an annotated Curatorial analysis & Lighting plan.

Studio kit: Week 3 structural relief panels, angle-poise lamps/torches for raking light tests, exhibition case-study cards, A3 Curatorial analysis boards, fineliners, tonal pencils

Arrival and starter

Arrival: Watch what happens when we shine a torch flat onto the front of a relief panel vs shining it low across the side ('raking light'). What changes?

Starter question: Why is 'raking light' (light shone from a shallow side or top angle) essential when exhibiting textured collagraphs and structural reliefs?

Teacher model (I do)

Step 1: Run a live raking-light test on my panel: I hold a directional lamp at 90 degrees (flat) and 25 degrees (raking top-left) to my Week 3 relief panel and observe the shadow shift.

Step 2: Draw the two lighting diagrams and patina highlights: I sketch a comparative lighting diagram on my Curatorial board, then skim dry chrome/chalk along the top-left flanges of my panel to lock in that raking light.

Step 3: Draft the Curatorial space & Audience analysis: I complete my four-part analysis evaluating how lighting, sightlines, grouping, and wall text shape viewer engagement.

Practice routes (Supported / Independent / Aspire)

Supported: Raking light tested, directional highlights applied to panel, and curatorial sheet completed.

Independent: Panel enhanced with directional patina, annotated lighting/wall plan drawn, and curatorial analysis written.

Aspire: Resolved directional panel, three-zone exhibition elevation, wall text, and critical evaluation.

TA and cover notes

TA focus: Set up two safe low-voltage LED desk lamps or torches at the front studio bench so pupils can test flat vs

raking light on their relief panels.

Staff prep: Staff preparation only: review how to demonstrate raking light on cardboard/foil relief and connect it to exhibition curation.